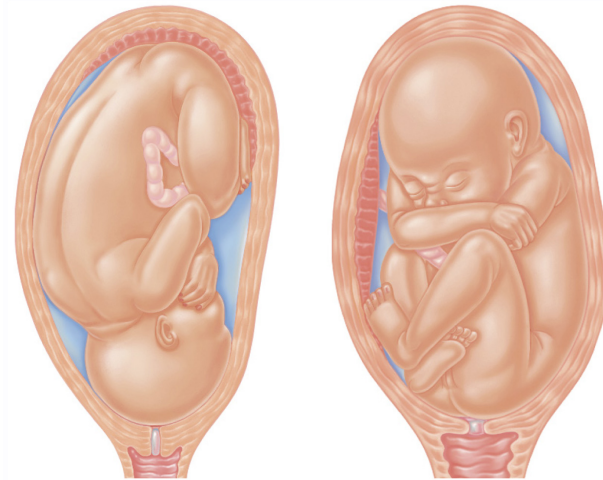




Cephalic presentation

Breech presentation

ASK A DOCTOR

What is perineal massage and how do I do it? Spending just five minutes a day massaging your perineum (the area between the vagina and anus) with oil could reduce your risk of tearing or having an [episiotomy](#) during the birth. It also means you're less likely to experience pain in that sensitive spot after the birth—even after having an episiotomy. Follow these steps to perform a perineal massage:

- Wash your hands. Apply a mild lubricant, like K-Y jelly, to your thumbs, then slide them an inch inside the vagina. Gently stretch the vagina until you feel a slight stinging sensation.
- When you feel that sensation, hold the pressure steady until you no longer feel the stinging. Then gently massage the lower half of the vagina with your thumbs. With your thumbs hooked in the vagina, pull forward to stretch the skin as you massage.
- Not sure you're doing the first part properly? Insert your fingers into the corners of your mouth and pull your mouth open to the sides for a similar “burning” sensation.